

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Volcanic eruption

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Follow the local volcano evacuation order and stay out of restricted zones. If ash is falling and you are not told to evacuate, stay indoors with windows and doors closed. Avoid river valleys where volcanic mudflows may travel.

Do now.

☐**Check official monitoring**

01

Use local emergency alerts and the responsible volcano observatory.

☐**Leave danger zones**

02

Take designated evacuation routes; do not approach the volcano to watch.

☐**Limit ash exposure**

03

Close outside-air openings and use eye protection and a well-fitting particulate respirator for necessary outdoor movement.

☐**Keep roads clear**

04

Avoid driving in ash unless necessary; visibility and engines can be affected.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Keep away from river valleys, exclusion areas and visible ash plumes. Use the best reachable intact shelter for ashfall while checking evacuation information. Avoid driving through heavy ash unless leaving a more immediate threat; ash can impair engines and visibility.

Watch for.

A particle respirator does not protect against volcanic gases.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Wait for reentry instructions. Do not climb a roof covered in ash; wet ash can overload structures.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Volcanic eruption · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/volcanic-eruption/>